High Revenue Airbnb in NYC

Analytical Blueprint for Airbnb New york

Objective: Uncover the core drivers of short-term rental profitability in th area of New York where there is a room for improvement.

Description of the Data

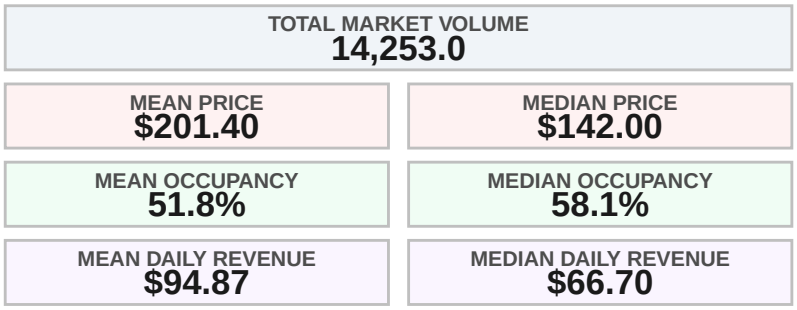
1. This data story explores the dataset of 14,253 bookable NYC Airbnb listings
2. I examine the core structural, geographic, and operational factors that distinguish highly profitable listings from underperforming ones.

Core Questions

1. Which boroughs and neighborhoods yield best revenues?
2. How do room types and pricing strategies influence occupancy rates?
3. Where are the best opportunities for new property acquisition or operational optimization?

Chart 1: NYC Airbnb Business Heavily Rely on Listings / Online Catalog

Statistics Regarding Market Volume, Pricing Metrics, Occupancy, and Daily Revenue

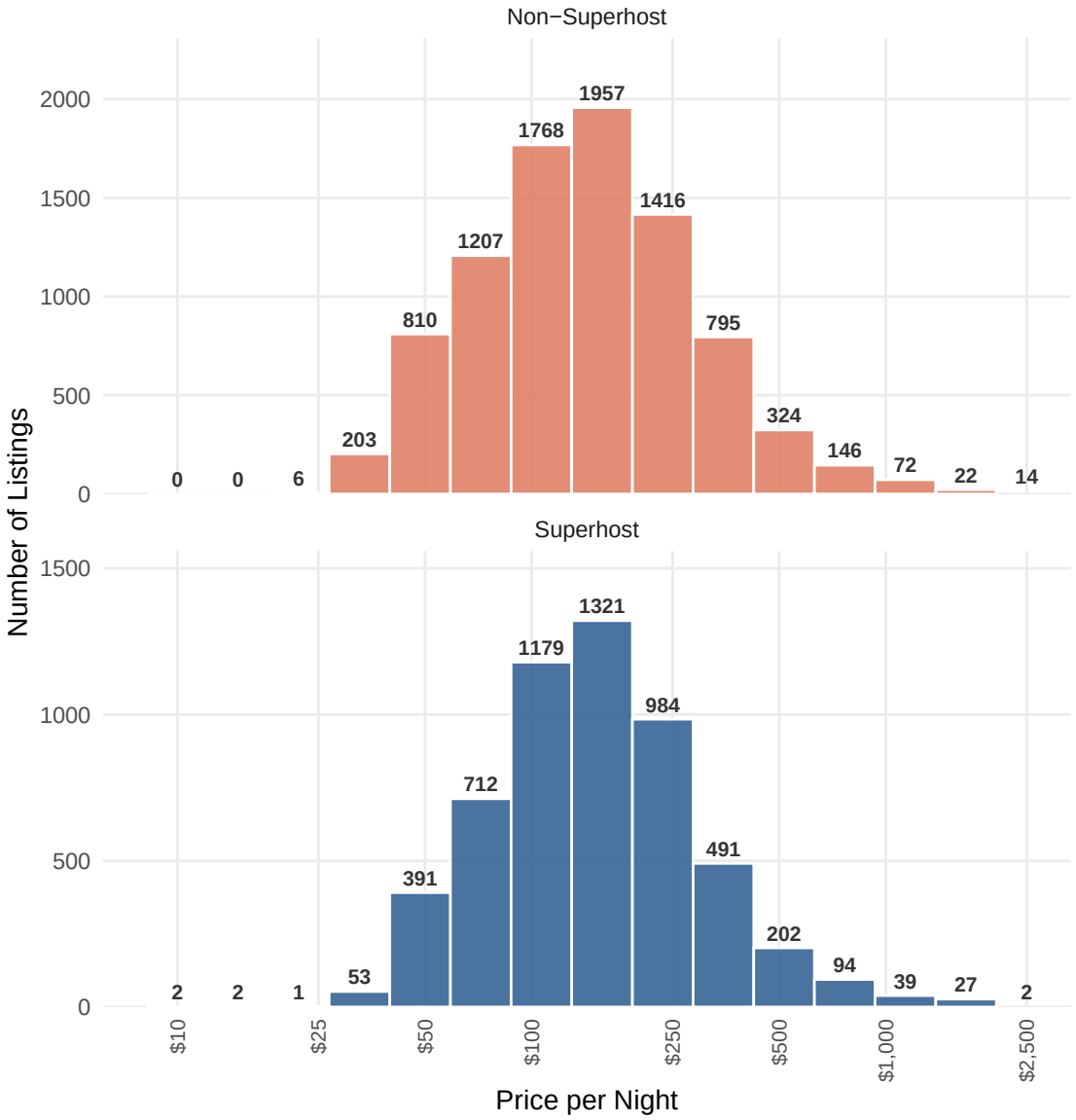


Source: NYC Airbnb listings data

Chart 1: Illustrates the foundational market baseline for NYC short-term rentals, anchored by a vast record of catalog of **14,253 listings**. The metrics highlight a notable financial skew where upper-tier properties pull average values above typical experiences, as the **mean price ($201.40)** and **mean daily revenue ($94.87)** exceed their respective medians of **$142.00** and **$66.70**. Simultaneously, steady property utilization is reflected by a **median occupancy rate of 58.1%** (and a mean of 51.8%), demonstrating how cumulative catalog volume and consistent demand sustain the local market.

Chart 2: From Spare Rooms to Institutional Portfolios: Host status splits the NYC Airbnb Price comparison

Comparison of Superhost & Non Superhost: Log−scale price distribution: Comparing Superhosts and Non−Superhosts



Source: NYC Airbnb listings data

Chart 2: Compares the log-scale price distributions of NYC Airbnb listings between Non-

Superhosts and Superhosts. Both host categories concentrate their listings heavily in the $100 to $250 price range, while Non-Superhosts maintain a significantly higher total volume of listings across the board.

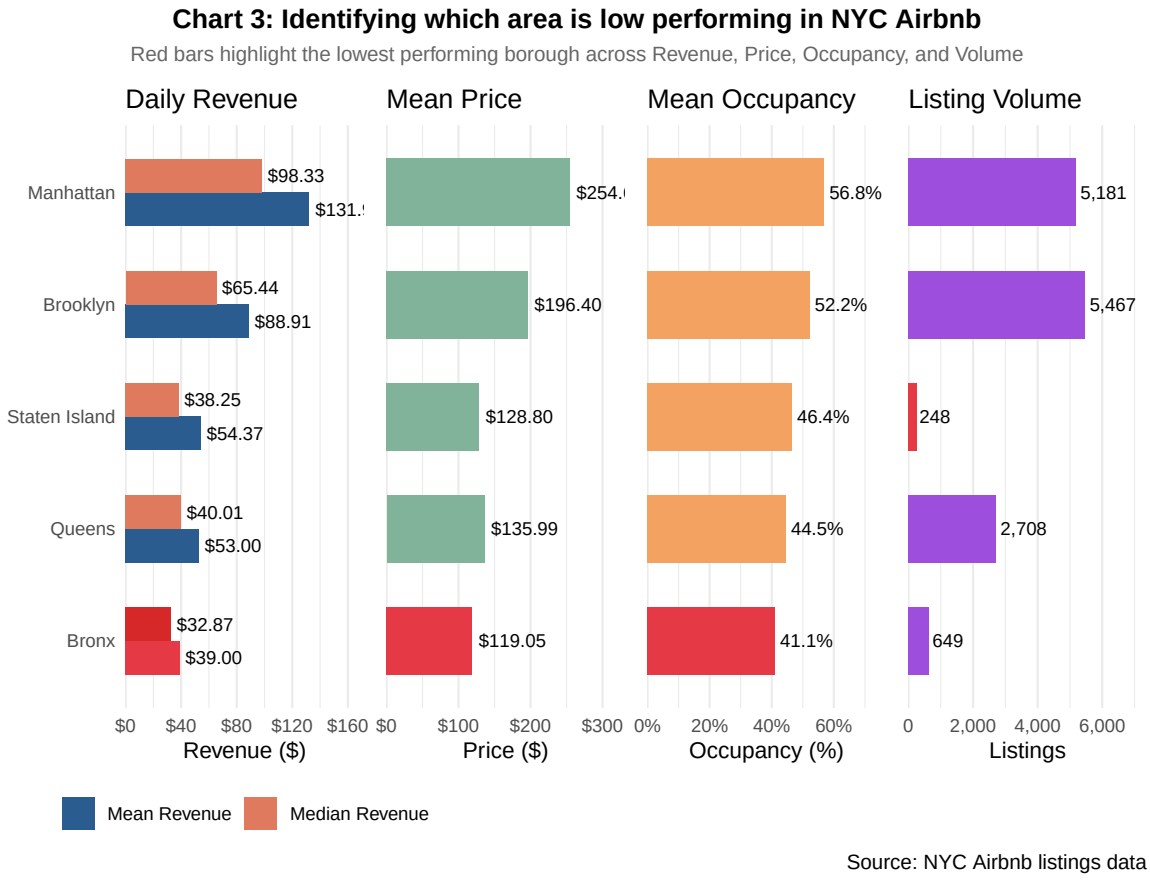


Chart 3: Breaks down NYC Airbnb performance by borough across daily revenue, mean price, occupancy rate, and listing volume, with red bars marking the lowest performers. **Manhattan** and **Brooklyn** lead the market in volume, pricing, and revenue, whereas the **Bronx** lags behind with the lowest figures in mean price ($119.05) and occupancy (41.1%), and **Staten Island** records the lowest inventory with just 248 listings.

The chart also shows that volume is not directly proportion with the Daily Revenue mean price and mean occupancy.

From the chart, question arises that what are the challenges or factors that play into these lower stats in Bronx (**mean price and mean occupancy**) and **listing volumes** in Staten Island.

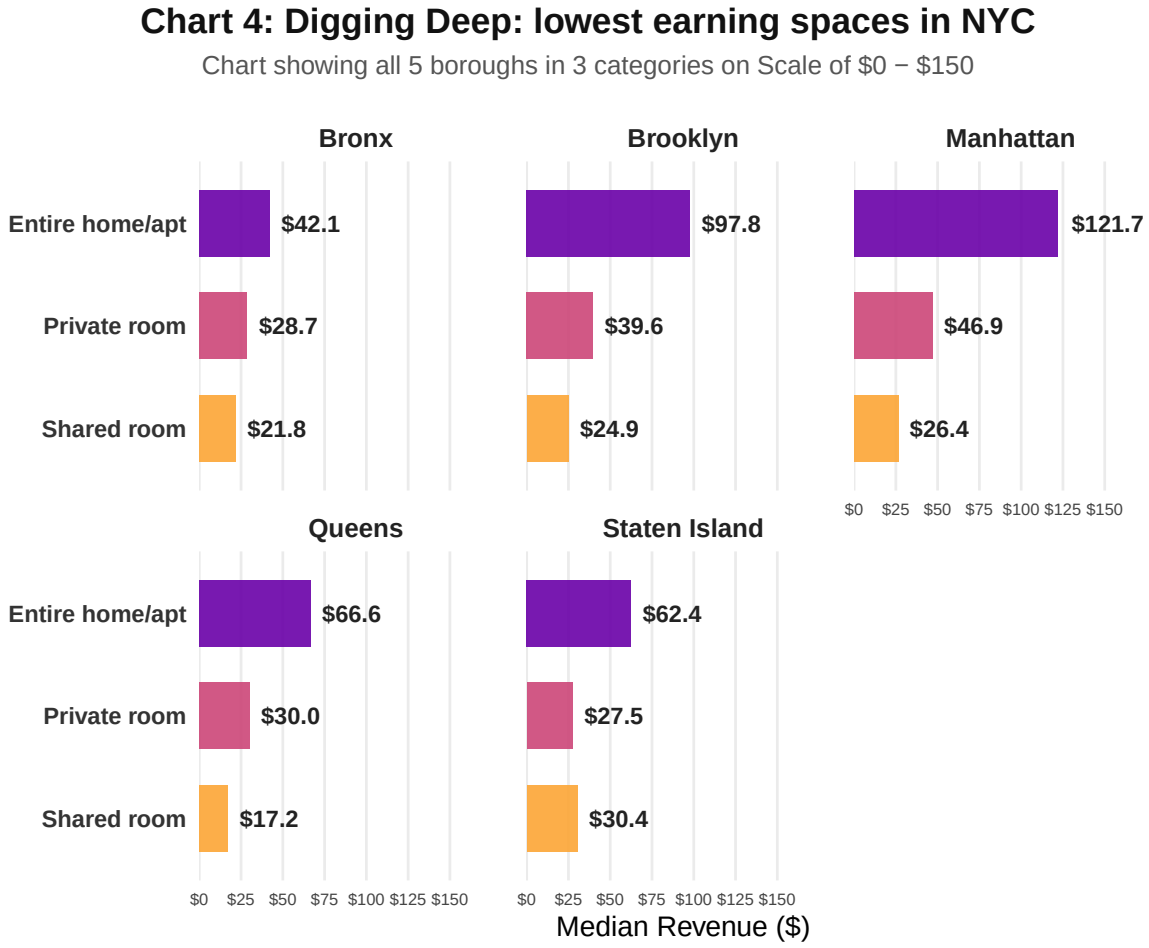


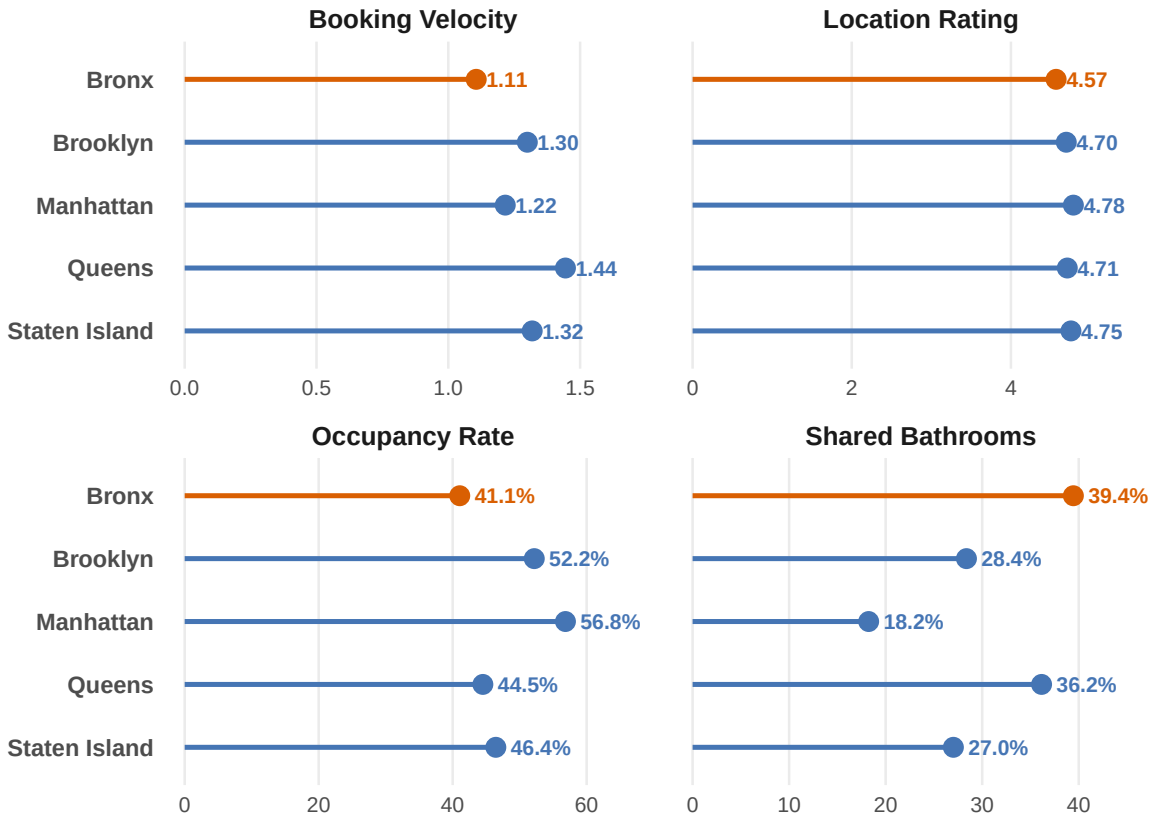
Chart 4: The core takeaway from Chart 4 ties directly back to the borough-level trends seen in Chart 3:

- **Entire Home/Apt Lag:** In Chart 4, **Entire home/apt** listings in the Bronx generate a median daily revenue of **$42.10**, making them the lowest-earning entire-home listings across all five NYC boroughs.
- **Private & Shared Room Shortfalls:** The Bronx's **Private room** ($28.70) and **Shared room** ($21.80) earnings rank as the **2nd lowest** in their respective room categories across New York City.
- **Cumulative Market Impact:** Combined with its borough-wide baseline in Chart 3, where the Bronx records the city's **lowest mean price ($119.05)** and **lowest mean**

occupancy (41.1%); these room-level deficits confirm that the Bronx is overall the lowest earning-yielding market in the NYC Airbnb ecosystem

Chart 5: Challenges faced by the listings in Bronx vs other Borough

Comparing occupancy, ratings, shared amenities, and booking velocity



The Bronx faces severe structural disadvantages across all key short-term rental performance metrics compared to the rest of New York City. It records the lowest occupancy rate in the city at **41.1%**, the slowest booking velocity at **1.11 reviews per month**, the lowest location rating at **4.57 out of 5**, and the cheapest average listing price at **$119.05**. Compounding these low demand and pricing figures, the Bronx also suffers from the highest proportion of shared bathrooms at **39.4%**, highlighting a lower-tier infrastructure that struggles to compete with more lucrative and fully equipped markets like Manhattan and Brooklyn.

Chart 6: Capitalizing on the Bronx Advantage: Quality and Engagement Metrics

Evaluating top−tier rating quality, value perception, and review volumes across NYC boroughs.



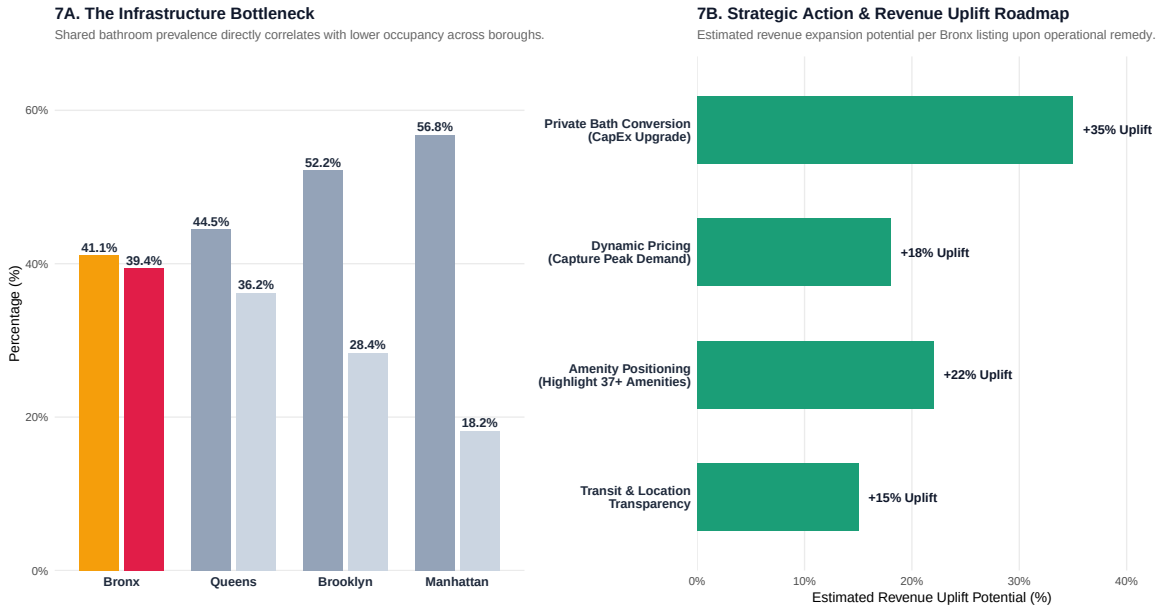
Chart 6 evaluates key quality and engagement metrics across New York City boroughs, highlighting the Bronx's strong foundation in guest satisfaction alongside opportunities for volume growth. The borough achieves competitive guest ratings with a mean rating of 4.71 and a value score of 4.65, closely matching core markets like Manhattan and Brooklyn. Although total review counts are lower—averaging 38.9 reviews—these consistent, top-tier quality scores demonstrate that Bronx listings maintain an excellent guest experience ready for strategic positioning and marketing.



- **Amenity Richness (Chart 7, Panel A):** The Bronx curve shifts rightward compared to Manhattan and other boroughs, proving that Bronx listings offer greater amenity detail and higher overall listing completeness.
- **Listing Accuracy (Chart 7, Panel B):** The Bronx curve tightly tracks NYC benchmarks near top ratings, demonstrating that Bronx hosts consistently deliver guest experiences that match or exceed their listing descriptions.

Chart 8: Strategic Resolution Roadmap for Bronx STR Optimization

From Infrastructure Remedy to Revenue Maximization: Converting Structural Challenges into High−Yield Investment.



Strategic Resolution & Remedy Summary

Strategic Pricing & Yield Management

1. Move beyond the discounting trap: Hold baseline price floors near $119.05 while utilizing dynamic pricing for peak seasons.
2. Leverage Quality: Use high review accuracy (4.71) to support optimal rate adjustments but without sacrificung perceived quality.

Targeted CapEx & Infrastructure Upgrades

1. Upgrade Bathrooms: Convert shared bathrooms (39.4%) to private en-suites to overcome the occupancy lag.
2. Showcase Amenities in the listings: Prominently feature the borough's high average amenity count (37.4) to drive bookings.

Positioning & Marketing Optimization

1. Highlight Space: Market entire-home listings based on square-foot value relative to cramped Manhattan units.
2. Ensure Transparency: Proactively highlight transit links upfront to offset lower location ratings (4.57).

Investor Acquisition & Portfolio Strategy

1. Low Acquisition Cost, High ROI Potential: Capitalize on lower acquisition prices in the Bronx to achieve superior cap rates.
2. Focus on Entire Homes inventory: Prioritize entire-home inventory to maximize revenue potential.